

NATHAN SUNDAY

University of Michigan
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EDUCATION

University of Michigan

PhD. Candidate in Economics

2027 (expected)

Master of Arts in Economics

2024

Makerere University

2019

Master of Arts in Economics

GPA: 4.86/5

Makerere University

2014

Bachelor of Science with Education (Mathematics and Economics)

GPA: 4.74/5

FACULTY ADVISOR

Dean Yang

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics (Primary)

Public Finance/Economics (Secondary)

WORK IN PROGRESS

”Commercial Property Taxes, Firm Behavior, and Fiscal Externalities”

“Old-Age Pension and Labor Market Outcomes of Younger Individuals: Evidence from Uganda”

- Awarded the prize for **Outstanding Third Year Paper**, 2024, Department of Economics, University of Michigan

“Economic Effects of Decentralization: Firm Level Evidence”

SELECTED PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS

“Does Corruption Explain the Decision to Invest and the Value of Investment? Revisiting Evidence from Sub-Saharan African Firms” (with Ibrahim Mike Okumu and Edward Bbaale), *Journal of International Development*, October 2025.

“Gender of a Manager and Firm Performance in Africa: Does the Business Environment Play a Moderating Role?” (with Ibrahim Okumu and Edward Bbaale), *Journal of International Development*, Vol. 36, No. 8, November 2024, pp. 3082–3124.

“How Specific Resilience Pillars Mitigate the Impact of Drought on Food Security: Evidence from Uganda” (with Rehema Kahunde, Blessing Atwine, Adesoji Adelaja, and Justin George), *Food Security*, Vol. 15, No. 1, September 2022, pp. 111-131(2023)

SELECTED BLOGS, POLICY BRIEFS, OPINION ARTICLES

“Impact of COVID-19 on Micro, Small, and Medium Businesses in Uganda” (blog with Paul Lakuma), *Brookings, Focus in Africa*, May 2020. [Link to the Article](#)

“The **Uganda Business Climate Index (BCI)**, between 2019 and 2021 (Co-authored)”. Some of the BCI reports can be found at the following links: [\[BCI, March 2019\]](#); [\[BCI, Sept 2019\]](#); [\[BCI, Dec 2019\]](#); [\[BCI, March 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, May 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, June 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, Dec 2020\]](#); [\[BCI, March 2021, Special Issue\]](#); [\[BCI, March 2021\]](#); [\[BCI, Aug 2021, Special Issue\]](#).

“A Rapid Assessment of the Effect of the COVID-19 Lockdown on Livelihoods and Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises in Uganda” (with Francis Mwesigye, Tony Odokonyero, and Mildred Barungi), *Economic Policy Research Centre*, Policy Note: 8, August 2021. [Link to the Report](#)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Graduate Research Award , Department of Economics, University of Michigan, \$3,000.	2025
Doctoral Research Grant , Rackham Graduate School, University of Michigan, \$3,000.	2025
Outstanding Third Year Paper Award, 2024 , Department of Economics, University of Michigan Paper: Old-Age Pension and Labor Market Outcomes of Younger Individuals: Evidence from Uganda.	
Structural Transformation of Agriculture and Rural Spaces (STARS) Fellowship Program , Cornell University, International Food Policy Research Institute, and Michigan State University.	2020
Thematic Research Grant (US\$ 11,000) , African Economic Research Consortium. Paper: “Gender of a manager and firm performance in Africa: Does the business environment play a moderating role”.	2019 - 2020
Scholarship for Masters degree , African Economic Research Consortium (AERC).	2016 - 2018
Undergraduate scholarship , Government of Uganda.	2011 - 2014

HONORS AND PERSONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

Best student , Master of Arts in Economics, Makerere University	2019
Overall best student , AERC Collaborative Masters Programme (CMAP)	2017
Best student , College of Education and External Studies, Makerere University	2014

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2024:** 6th World Bank/IFS/ODI Public Finance Conference, Washington DC
- 2019:** African Economic Research Consortium (AERC) Bi-Annual Research Workshop, Nairobi, Kenya

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

PhD Fellow , National Planning Authority, Uganda	May - Aug 2024
Research Analyst , Economic Policy Research Centre, Uganda	2019 - 2021
Labor Support Officer , Research Unit, Ministry of Gender, Labor & Social Development, Uganda	2018 - 2019

SKILLS

Languages: English (Proficient)

Software: Stata (Advanced), R (Intermediate), LaTeX (Advanced), MatLab (Intermediate)

OTHERS

Citizenship: Citizen of Uganda (F-1 Visa)